

Information on Participation in the CueLens Study

1. What is this study about?

The CueLens study investigates whether a mobile Android app can help to reduce subjective smoking craving in everyday life in the short term after the presentation of smoking-related images.

Participation is very simple: the app shows smoking-related images and asks you either to assign a suitable description or to match another image. Afterwards, you indicate how strong your current smoking craving is.

The app is a study prototype. It is not a smoking cessation programme and not a medical treatment.

2. Who is conducting the study?

The person responsible for conducting the study is:

Stefan Berger

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The academic supervision is provided by Department VI – Computer Science and Media at the Berliner Hochschule für Technik as part of the Medical Informatics degree programme.

3. Who can participate?

You can participate if all of the following conditions are met:

- You are between 30 and 65 years old.
- You currently smoke at least ten cigarettes per day.
- You can read German or English.
- You live permanently in Germany or Switzerland.
- You have an Android smartphone or Android tablet with internet access.
- You are willing to use the app during the study period and to submit a total of 20 self-reports on smoking craving.

You may participate in the study no more than once. Eligibility is checked on the basis of the information you provide yourself. Statistical methods will be used to check the plausibility of the self-reported information and the self-reports on smoking craving. No identity document check and no medical tests of smoking status will be carried out. Please note that false information cannot be used for the study and that deception may lead to legal disadvantages or exclusion from the study.

4. How does participation work?

During the two-week study period, the CueLens app guides you through 20 individual study situations. In each study situation, smoking-related images are shown to you. Afterwards, you rate your current smoking craving on a scale from 0 to 100.

There is a minimum interval of a few hours between individual study situations so that the self-reports do not immediately follow one another. Nevertheless, it may easily happen that all study situations are completed after only 7 days. The app can optionally remind you to use it by means of notifications.

An internet connection is required to install and use the app. The amount of data transmitted for the self-reports is small. The size of the app installation depends on the selected range of functions. To avoid additional costs, the app should preferably be installed and used via Wi-Fi.

5. What data will be collected?

Only data required for conducting, evaluating, and reimbursing the study will be collected. This includes in particular:

- name and email address for organising participation,
- age and smoking status for checking the eligibility criteria,
- up to 20 self-reports on subjective smoking craving,
- bank details for payment of an expense allowance.

The scientific evaluation is carried out using anonymised study results. Further information on the processing of personal and health-related data, storage locations, storage periods, recipients, withdrawal, and your rights can be found in the separate privacy policy.

6. Are images or camera data transmitted?

The app and the server exchange only information on smoking craving and on the number of self-reports submitted so far. The app may optionally also use your own image files or camera images for local image recognition, but these images are processed only within the app. They are not transmitted to the study server and are not stored permanently. After each processing step, they are discarded.

7. What burdens or risks are there?

The app shows smoking-related trigger cues. This may temporarily trigger or increase smoking craving. If you experience the use of the app as unpleasant or stressful, you may interrupt use or discontinue participation.

The app does not replace medical advice. If you experience severe symptoms, strong addictive pressure, or other health problems, please contact an appropriate medical, psychological, or addiction counselling service.

8. What is the benefit of participation?

An immediate health benefit is not the aim of the study. Rather, the study aims to scientifically examine whether the different effects described in laboratory studies of assigning other images or descriptions to smoking-related images can be measured with a mobile app in everyday life.

Your participation can help to improve the understanding and technical development of digital interventions in the field of tobacco use and smoking craving.

9. Voluntary participation and discontinuation

Participation is voluntary. You may discontinue participation at any time, and discontinuing participation will not result in any disadvantages for you. More detailed information on data protection in the event of discontinuation can be found in the privacy policy.

10. Expense allowance

An expense allowance will be paid if the eligibility criteria are met and all self-reports required for the study have been submitted.

The expense allowance is €15.00 for participants from Germany and CHF 15.00 for participants from Switzerland. Bank details are required for payment. These are handled separately from the anonymised study results.

If technical problems occur, please report them promptly. We will then support you in resolving them and, if necessary, grant you an extension for submitting the reports. In the event of incomplete participation, the expense allowance cannot be paid.

11. Contact

For questions about the study, technical problems, data protection, or withdrawal of your consent, please contact cuelens@each-and-every.de.

Thank you for your participation. We hope you enjoy taking part.